INCH-POUND
A-A-58047E
June 7, 2021
SUPERSEDING
A-A-58047D
December 23, 2016

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SIGNAL GENERATOR

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This signal generator generates a highly stable, continuous wave (CW), and modulated signal. The unit generates amplitude modulation (AM), frequency modulation (FM), phase modulation (ØM), and pulse modulation (PM) signals with internal or external signals for modulation on demand as required by the user.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The signal generator covered by this commercial item description (CID) shall be commercially available equipment that has factory-installed options and/or may be modified to the extent necessary to meet the following description. The test set shall be class 3, in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800.

2.1 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this CID and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this CID shall take precedence. Nothing in this CID, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Item description. Signal generator.

3.2 Radio frequency operating bandwidth. The signal generator shall have a minimum operating bandwidth span from 10 megahertz (MHz) to 26.5 gigahertz (GHz).

3.3 Modulation. The signal generator shall provide radio frequency (RF) output with AM, FM, ØM, and PM modulation and have external modulation capability. The signal generator shall have external-pulsed carrier-function capability.

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to AFLCMC/EZSS, 2145 Monahan Way, Area B, Wright-Patterson AFB, OH 45433-7017 or email to engineering.standards@us.af.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

FSC 6625

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Internal time-base aging. The internal-reference frequency aging shall be ≤ ±5•10-9 per 24 hours or ≤ ±8•10-7/year with a 10 MHz time base.

3.5 Radio-frequency resolution. The signal-generator frequency resolution shall be ≤ 0.01 hertz (Hz).

3.6 Marker frequencies. The signal generator shall have the capability of generating ≥ 8 marker frequencies.

3.7 RF spectral-harmonics content. The signal generator shall have ≤ -30 decibels (dB) of harmonic content at +10 decibels per milliwatt (dBm) up to the L band 1 to 2 GHz spectrum segment in CW mode. The signal generator shall have ≤ -50 dB of harmonic content at +10 dBm up to the K band 18 to 27 GHz spectrum segment in CW mode. See table II.

3.8 Sweep functions. The signal generator shall be capable of performing ≥ 16 linear, logarithmic, and/or continuous-step frequency sweeps with a minimum time span from 120µS to 60S, and output-level variation ≤ ±5.0 dB when in automatic mode or set to "on demand" by the user.

3.9 Spurious signals. The total spurious-signal content of the signal generator, including side bands and sub-harmonics, accompanying the desired RF signal shall be ≤ -30 dB below the maximum signal level.

3.10 Power output level. The signal generator shall be able to provide a minimum of +10 dB @ 50 Ohms (Ω) throughout the spectrum.

3.11 Power output range. The signal generator shall have a power output span ≥ -130 dBm to +10 dBm throughout the spectrum.

3.12 Stepped attenuator. The signal generator shall have user-selectable attenuation levels in linear mode providing 1dB @ 50 Ω steps spanning the amplitude range specified in section 3.11 throughout the spectrum.

3.13 RF output amplitude tolerance. The signal generator shall have a minimum power-output amplitude variation tolerance of ±0.5 dBm.

3.14 RF output amplitude resolution. The signal generator shall have a minimum power-output amplitude resolution of ±0.1 dBm.

3.15 Broadband noise. The level of broadband noise in the RF signal shall be ≤ -130 dB below the carrier-output level, as measured at the RF OUT connector and into a 50 Ω load. The frequency bands are designated by IEEE 521-2019, shown here for reference and guidance. Frequency-response spectral flatness and amplitude characteristics shall exhibit a continuous function slope without acute changes or stepped responses in magnitude as frequencies extend and overlap from band to band. The instrument-band selections need not follow IEEE spectrum span or coverage.

3.16 Phase noise figures. The signal-generator broadband-noise figures shall be measured at 0 dBm @ 50 Ω. See table I.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Frequency-Distribution Broadband Noise.

Phase Noise by Frequency Bands dB/Hz 0% Mod (Frequency Offset ≤ 100 Hz)				
ITU Band	Frequency	Designation (IEEE)	Frequency Band (IEEE)	Phase Noise (dB)
5	30 kHz ~ 300 kHz	Ultra Sound		≤ -90
6	300 kHz ~ 3000 kHz	Hyper Sound		
7	3 MHz ~ 30 MHz	HF*		
8	30 MHz ~ 300 MHz	VHF*		
9	300 MHz ~ 3000 MHz	UHF*	300 ~ 1000 MHz	≤ -90
		L Band	1 ~ 2 GHz	≤ -85
		S Band	2 ~ 4 GHz	≤ -80
10	3 GHz ~ 30 GHz	C Band	4 ~ 8 GHz	≤ -73
		X	8 ~ 12 GHz	≤ -70
		Ku	12 ~ 18 GHz	≤ -65
		K	18 ~ 27 GHz	≤ -60*
11	30 GHz ~ 300 GHz	Ka	27 ~ 40 GHz	
		W	-	-
* Extended value of overlapping frequencies.				

TABLE II. Frequency Bands Harmonic-Noise Levels.

Harmonic Noise (dB Values are **not** absolute; there is a typical overlap of 3 to 6dB)			
Frequency Bands (ITU)	Frequencies (IEEE)		Magnitude
Band 4	3 kHz ~ 30 kHz		≤ -30 dB/Hz (typical)
Band 5	30 kHz ~ 300 kHz		
Band 6	300 kHz ~ 3 MHz		
Band 7	3 MHz ~ 30 MHz		
Band 8	30 MHz ~ 300 MHz		≤ -35 dB/Hz (typical)
Band 9	300 MHz ~ 3 GHz	(UHF 300 MHz ~1 GHz)	
		(L Band 1 GHz ~ 2 GHz)	≤ -30 dB/Hz (typical)
		(S Band 2 GHz ~ 4 GHz)	≤ -50 dB/Hz (typical)
Band 10	3 GHz ~ 30 GHz	(C Band 4 GHz ~ 8 GHz)	
		(X Band 8 GHz ~ 12 GHz)	
		(Ku Band 12 GHz ~ 18 GHz)	
		(K Band 18 GHz ~ 27 GHz)	≤ -40 dB/Hz (typical)
Band 11	30 GHz ~ 300 GHz	(Ka Band 27 GHz ~ 40 GHz)	
		(V Band 40 GHz ~ 75 GHz)	-
		(W Band 75 GHz ~ 110 GHz)	-

3.17 Triggering. The signal generator shall have external triggering inputs that trigger the sweep function for analog frequency, step frequency, and CW power-sweep functions as selected by the user. Sweep control shall be menu-driven with internal and external capability. The external modulation and sweep must be controlled through a variable, proportional-voltage source (typical 0 ~ 10 volts direct current (VDC)).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.18 Internal and external reference. The signal generator shall have an external reference input and output connector for calibration and comparison procedures.

3.19 Modulation. The signal generator shall have internal and external modulation capability for AM, FM, ØM, and PM.

3.20 Design and construction. The signal generator shall be used in both bench-top and rack-mount environments. The signal generator is a commercial item subject to commercial-product regulatory standards. The signal generator shall be designed and constructed in accordance with all applicable European Union (EU) requirements with the "CE" marking affixed, International Organization for Standardization (ISO), the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC), the International Telecommunication Union (ITU), Underwriters Laboratories (UL), and the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). The signal generator shall be compliant with the Restriction of Use of Hazardous Substances (RoHS) and Waste from Electrical and Electronic Equipment (WEEE) guidelines and policies. It shall be designed and constructed so that no parts will work loose in service, and to withstand the strains, jars, vibrations, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, installation, and service.

3.21 System safety. The signal generator shall comply with all sections of the UL 1449 standard for electrical safety and the IEC 61010-1.

3.22 Sound levels. The signal-generator acoustic noise shall conform to sound-level requirements of ISO 7779 and measured in accordance with ISO 8253, section 2.

3.23 Electrostatic discharge (ESD). The design of the signal generator shall preclude equipment damage due to ESD, protect personnel from electrical shock due to static charging, and prevent ignition of explosive atmospheres due to sparking in accordance with ANSI/ESD-S20.20-2014, section 7.0, ESD Control Program.

3.24 Electromagnetic interference (EMI). The signal generator's EMI emissions shall be in accordance with the radiated-emission and susceptibility requirements of MIL-PRF-28800; MIL-STD-461, sections RE102 and RS103; IEC 1000-2-5; and the emitted radiation absorption and radiation limits of CFR, Title 47, Parts 15.109 and 15.209.

3.25 Service life. The design of the signal generator shall be such that, under normal use and operation, the service repair can be performed according to MIL-PRF-28800, sections 3.14.2 and 3.14.3.

3.26 Port damage. The output port shall withstand up to 10 volts alternating current (VAC) or volts direct current (VDC), or 33-dB levels (typical, 2W) without damaging the internal circuitry.

3.27 Connectors. The system shall have an angled physical contact (APC) 2.4-mm-type connector and an APC 3.5-mm adapter for the microwave-radio-frequency output. It shall have Bayonet Neill-Concelman (BNC)-type connectors for other front- and rear-panel inputs and outputs. A general-purpose-interface-bus (GPIB) interface with an IEC 60488 (formerly IEEE-488.2) protocol connector is required for compatibility and control functions.

3.28 Operating-temperature range. The signal generator shall meet the specifications listed herein with full capabilities within the temperature range of 32 to 122 °F (0 to 50 °C) after tests in MIL-PRF-28800, section 4.5.5.1.1, have been performed for class 3 equipment classification per MIL-PRF-28800, table 11.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.29 Storage-temperature range. The signal generator shall meet or exceed manufacturer's specifications for stored equipment after tests of MIL-PRF-28800, section 4.5.5.1, have been performed for instruments in the range of class 3 equipment classification per MIL-PRF-28800, table 11.

3.30 Altitude requirements. The signal generator shall meet its operating performance and accuracy while operating at an altitude of 8,000 feet (2,438 meters). The equipment shall meet its performance and accuracy requirements for operating and non-operating storage as specified in MIL-PRF-28800, sections 3.8.3 and 4.5.5.2 respectively, at this altitude.

3.31 Heat dissipation and ventilation. Ventilation shall be sufficient to allow for proper heat dissipation that can be achieved by either passive or active methods in order to meet MIL-PRF-28800, section 4.5.5.1, under temperature and humidity tests for class 3 equipment classification per MIL-PRF-28800, table 11.

3.32 Calibration and maintenance adjustments. No special tools, software, technical manuals, or documentation shall be required for the alignment, adjustment, repair, and calibration of the signal generator, except those provided with the signal generator. A software license shall be issued for each physical instrument when the system is designed for computer-based calibration. Software licenses needed to perform the alignment/adjustment process (where required by the manufacturer) shall be valid for the life of the instrument and shall be included with the signal generator. Any special or unique accessories not common to a secondary-calibration laboratory required for calibration of this item shall be furnished by the manufacturer, to include, but not limited to, software, fixtures, tools, and standards.

3.33 Calibration period. The design of the signal generator shall provide readily accessible calibration and maintenance adjustments. The calibration adjustments shall be accessible without removal of the test-set case or modules. The calibration interval shall be based on a period of one calendar year or an operating interval of 2,080 hours, whichever occurs first. At the end of this interval, 85 percent of the units shall remain within calibration tolerances in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, section 3.12.

3.34 Reliability. The design of the signal generator shall be such that under normal use and operation, the mean time between failures (MTBF) shall exceed 2,080 hours of operation with a statistical certainty equal to or greater than 95 percent in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, section 3.13, based on an 8-hour workday, 40-hour week, and 52-week interval. The manufacturer shall be able to reasonably establish the claim and certify with NIST traceability that the offered equipment is capable of the required level of reliability by meeting or exceeding MIL-PRF-28800, sections 3.13 and 4.5.8.1.

3.35 Built-in test equipment and diagnostics. The signal generator shall be equipped with built-in test and diagnostic capability that performs a system test evaluating all functional characteristics of the instrument at "Power On" or "Cold Start" in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, section 6.5.2.6.

3.36 Maintainability. The signal generator shall meet the human-engineering factors of ergonomics for operational and maintainability criteria providing access to controls, internal components, and adjustments in accordance with MIL-STD-1472, sections 5.9 through 5.9.18, and MIL-PRF-28800, section 6.6.2.4.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.37 Preventive maintenance. Preventive maintenance shall not require more than 15 minutes per 30-day period. Preventive maintenance shall not require breaking of the equipment seams where calibration seals would normally be placed in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, section 3.14.2.

3.38 Corrective maintenance. The signal generator shall be designed to meet reparability criteria in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, section 3.14.1.

3.39 Electrical power sources and connections. The signal-generator equipment shall operate from commercial, military, and shipboard power sources with a nominal voltage of 120 voltage root-mean-square (Vrms), single-phase alternating current (AC) (±10%) at line frequencies of 50 Hz and 60 Hz, in accordance with MIL-PRF-28800, sections 3.5.1.12 and 3.5.1.12a.

3.40 Electrical surge. The signal generator shall be able to provide surge protection that meets UL 1449, section 38; IEC 61000-4-4; and IEC 61010-1.

3.41 Noise suppression. The signal generator shall be able to operate with electrical noises and harmonic content present on the alternating-current power source with frequencies in the 30 Hz to 50 kHz range and levels varying from line level of 41.6 dB ±1 dB (108 to 132 VAC) measured at the power input in accordance with UL 1283, IEC/EN 60939-1 and under the guidance of the IEEE-519 standard.

3.42 Dimensions. The signal generator shall comply with the width and depth of the EIA/ECA-310-E standard equipment rack configuration.

3.43 Rack mount. The signal generator shall be capable of being rack mounted in a standard EIA/ECA-310-E equipment rack and, if required, include a rack-mount conversion kit that meets the requirements of MIL-PRF-28800, section 3.6.4.14.1.

3.44 Weight. The total weight of the signal generator, excluding accessories and manuals, shall comply with MIL-STD-1472 for weight and size restrictions for single-person lift and handling, and shall not exceed a one-person lift ≤ 35 pounds (15.6 kilograms).

3.45 Markings. All warning decals and instrument-category ratings must conform to commercial safety standards and be visible by the user in accordance with commercial product-safety labeling regulations and MIL-STD-130. Markings shall be applied with paint, decals, engraving, or molding, and shall be the largest size possible. Warning/Danger text shall be lusterless red.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials or biobased content to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation, Part 23.403.

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Packaging. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Source of documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.1.1 Government documents. Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil/.

7.1.2 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR). Copies of CFRs may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402, or online at https://www.ecfr.gov/cgi-bin/ECFR?page=browse.

7.1.3 Electronic Components Industry Association (ECIA). Copies of EIAs may be obtained from the Electronic Components Industry Association, 310 Maxwell Road, Suite 200, Alpharetta, GA 30009, or online at https://www.ecianow.org/.

7.1.4 EOS/ESD Association. Copies of EOS/ESD standards may be obtained from the EOS/ESD Association, Inc. 7900 Turin Road, Building 3, Rome, NY 13440, or online at https://www.esda.org.

7.1.5 IEC Standards. Copies of ISO/IEC standards may be obtained from the IEC Regional Centre for North America (IEC-ReCNA) 446 Main Street, 16th Floor Worcester, MA 01608, or online at https://www.iec.ch/.

7.1.6 Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE). Copies of these documents may be obtained from IEEE Operations Center, 445 Hoes Lane, Piscataway, NJ, 08854, or online at https://www.standards.ieee.org.

7.1.7 Underwriters Laboratories (UL). Copies of these documents may be obtained from Underwriters Laboratories, 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062, or online at https://www.ul.com/.

7.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents must specify: title, number, date of this CID, the issue of the ASSIST Online (https://assist.dla.mil) to be used in the solicitation, and preservation and packaging requirements.

7.3 Key words.

Calibration

7.4 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodian:
Air Force - 84

Preparing Activity:
Air Force - 84

Reviewer:
Army – MI

Agent:
Air Force - 110
(Project 6625-2021-005)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Because organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.